

Door

From the mosque of al-Ashraf Barsbay ("al-Ashrafiyya")

Burji Mamluk, 826-27 AH / 1423-24 CE

W: 105 cm; H: 198 cm

Hall 4

Inv. no. 445

A pair of door leaves from the mosque of Sultan al-Ashraf Barsbay ("al-Ashrafiyya") on al-Mu'izz Street, constructed through interlocking joinery and decorated with geometric star pattern enlivened with arabesques in a typically Mamluk style. Although many of the original wood and ivory inlays have been lost or replaced, the sophistication of the original composition remains evident. The upper and lower panels, now missing, likely once bore inscriptions or additional ornament framed by delicate metal fixtures, such as those surviving on the upper left panel, cast in the form of intertwining leaves or branches. The scale, proportion, and decorative vocabulary of the leaves align closely with other wooden furnishings associated with Barsbay's patronage, suggesting they may have served as a doorway or the leaves of a large cupboard.